

The maize isn't reaching the plate.

A sixteen-month performance review of Kenya's School Feeding Programme finds a well-attended, well-monitored system that its own supply chain is quietly failing to feed.

1,000	16 mo	8	3.32M
SCHOOLS REPORTING	REPORTING PERIOD	REGIONS COVERED	MEALS SERVED

MEAL COVERAGE RATE

39.6%



Target: 100% · Gap: 60.4pp — only 2 in 5 enrolled students receive a meal on a given day.

Attendance is holding near **80%** and dropout near target, proving demand for the programme is real. But **supply delivery (49.3%)**, **stock-outs (50.2%)** and **ration fullness (49.6%)** are all failing at the same systemic magnitude — a single upstream problem, not three separate ones.

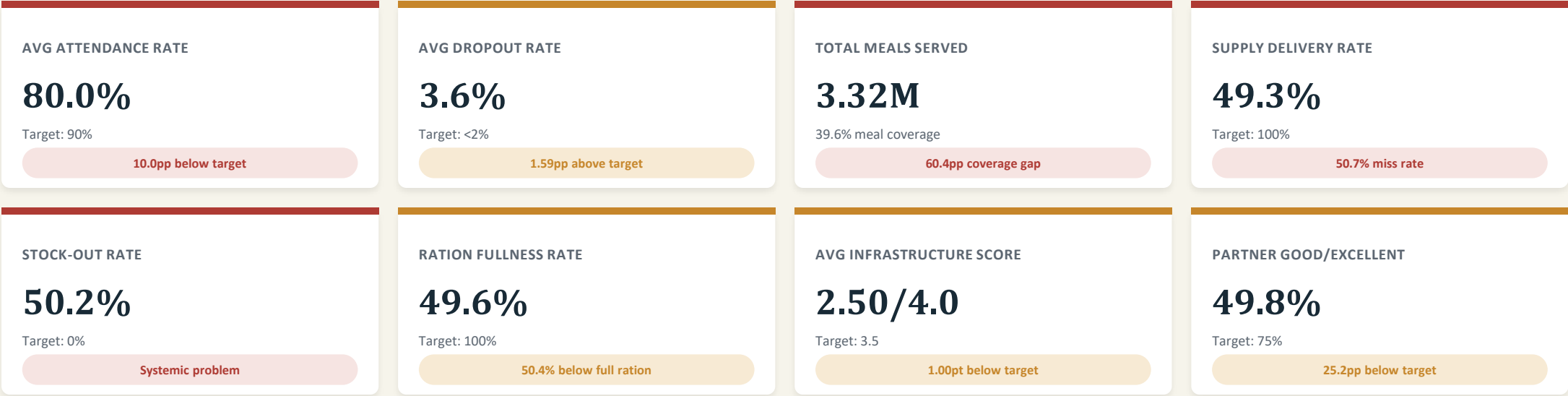


BOTTOM LINE

Half of all schools go without supply in a given period, and of those that do receive food, half report running out before the next delivery. Fixing procurement and stock management is the single highest-leverage intervention available to this programme.

Nine indicators, one story

Programme-wide averages against the Indicator Performance Tracking Table (IPTT) targets, Jan-25 – Apr-26.



KEY INSIGHTS

- Attendance (80.0%) sits 10.0pp below target — structural barriers such as poverty and distance, not the food itself, appear to be limiting impact.
- Meal coverage of ~39.6% means only 2 in 5 enrolled students actually receive a meal on any given day.
- Only 49.3% of schools received supplies in the period, and 50.2% reported stock-outs — a supply chain failure, not a demand-side one.
- An infrastructure score of 2.50/4.0 shows water, kitchen, storage and utensil gaps limit safe meal prep even where food is delivered.

Where the food gets lost

Half of all scheduled deliveries never arrive; of those that do, half run out before the next one.



NON-DELIVERY RATE

50.7%

Schools without supplies

STOCK-OUT RATE

50.2%

Zero stock at time of survey

RATION FULLNESS

49.6%

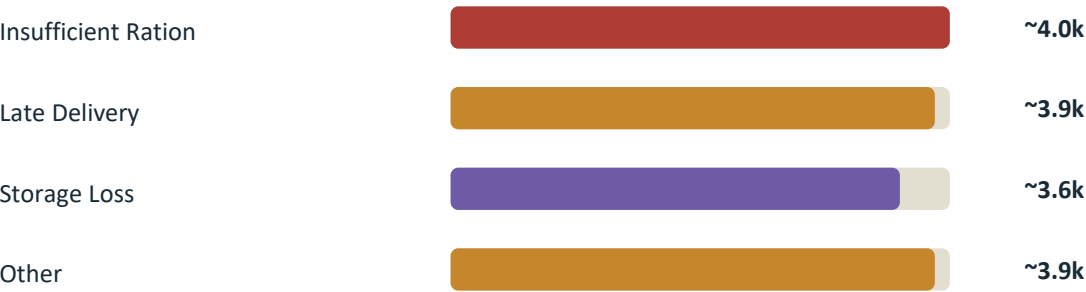
Full ration, when supplied

AVG MISSED MEAL DAYS

3.5

Days / school / month

STOCK-OUT CAUSES (PROGRAMME-WIDE OCCURRENCES)



Causes split almost evenly (~25% each) — a multi-point breakdown, not a single fixable link.

INFRASTRUCTURE & COMPLAINT GAPS (% OF SCHOOLS)



Kids are showing up. The food isn't.

Attendance sits below target but is remarkably stable — the constraint isn't demand for the programme.



AVG ATTENDANCE RATE

80.0%

Target: 90% · 10.0pp gap

AVG DROPOUT RATE

3.6%

Target: <2% · 1.59pp over

BEST ATTENDANCE MONTH

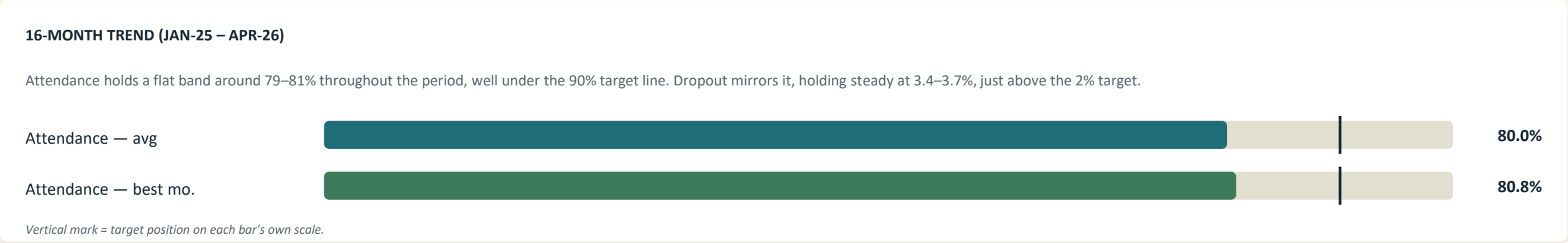
80.8%

Apr-25 — programme peak

ATTENDANCE VS. TARGET GAP

10.0pp

Consistent, critical gap



- Attendance is flat across all sixteen months and does not move with supply delivery — structural barriers like poverty and distance likely dominate over food access alone.
- The dominant reported dropout reason is uniformly "poverty and hunger" — feeding alone cannot resolve poverty-driven dropout without complementary social protection.

A uniformly stressed system

No region is meeting target — the crisis is programme-wide, not concentrated in one geography.



BEST ATTENDANCE REGION

Western

80.2% avg attendance

HIGHEST DROPOUT REGION

Nyanza

3.7% avg dropout

BEST SUPPLY REGION

Nyanza

50.4% supply rate

WORST STOCK-OUT REGION

Central

51.0% stock-out rate

Region	Att %	Drop %	Meals	Supply %	Stock-out %	Infra	Good Ptnr %	Status
Central	79.8	3.6	407K	49.8	51.0	2.48	48.8	Weak
Coast	79.8	3.5	387K	49.0	49.5	2.53	49.3	Weak
Eastern	79.9	3.6	431K	49.0	49.9	2.49	49.2	Weak
Nairobi	80.0	3.7	402K	48.9	50.7	2.51	50.2	Moderate
North Eastern	80.0	3.5	454K	48.0	50.7	2.52	51.2	Moderate
Nyanza	79.8	3.7	427K	50.4	50.4	2.46	49.3	Weak
Rift Valley	80.2	3.6	370K	50.2	49.7	2.47	49.5	Moderate
Western	80.2	3.6	447K	49.4	49.7	2.50	50.7	Moderate

Regional read: the spread between best and worst region on every indicator is under 3pp — a national systems failure, not a local one. North Eastern serves the most meals (454K) yet still posts a 50.7% stock-out rate.

Nine indicators against target

Achievement % = cumulative ÷ target × 100 (lower-is-better indicators use an inverse calculation).



Indicator	Unit	Baseline	Target	Cumulative	Achievement	Status
1. School Attendance Rate	%	79.8	90	80.0	89%	Off Track
2. Student Dropout Rate	%	3.4	2	3.6	100%	On Track
3. Meal Coverage Rate	%	40.5	100	39.6	40%	Critical
4. Supply Delivery Rate	%	50.4	100	49.3	49%	Critical
5. Ration Fullness Rate	%	51.4	100	49.6	50%	Critical
6. Stock-out Rate	%	50.3	0	50.2	2%	Critical
7. Infrastructure Score	/4	2.52	3.5	2.50	71%	Off Track
8. Partner Good/Excellent %	%	50.6	75	49.8	66%	Off Track

Reading the IPTT: five of nine indicators are Critical, three more Off Track — only dropout registers On Track. The four supply-side indicators cluster at 0–50% achievement, the clearest signal this is one root-cause failure. Cumulative values are barely different from baseline: sixteen months of monitoring hasn't moved the underlying supply chain.

Fix the pipe before scaling the tap

Nine actions, sequenced by urgency and time horizon.

Critical — Supply chain, meal coverage, stock-outs — fix first **High** — Attendance, dropout, infrastructure — medium-term **Medium** — Partner performance, data quality — systems work

1

Fix Supply Chain — Immediate Procurement Reform

Real-time supply tracking, 30-day county buffer stocks, SLA enforcement with penalties. ~50% of schools currently receive zero food.

Month 1–3

2

Scale Budget to Achieve 100% Meal Coverage

Budget covers only ~39% of enrolled students. Commission a needs-based review; explore WFP co-financing.

Month 1–6

3

Eliminate Stock-outs via School-Level Stock Management

Digital mobile stock tracking, automated resupply triggers below 5-day threshold, monthly unannounced audits.

Month 1–3

4

Multi-Sector Approach to Achieve 90% Attendance

Integrate cash transfers, school health, uniform/textbook schemes — feeding alone is insufficient.

Month 3–12

5

Reduce Dropout via Poverty Linkages

Link feeding database to social-protection registries; identify dropout-risk students for bursaries.

Month 3–12

6

Ring-fence Infrastructure Budget

15% of budget for water, kitchen, storage, utensils via a 2-year County Infrastructure Investment Plan.

Year 1–2

7

Anti-Corruption & Community Oversight

Oversight committees at every school, published beneficiary lists, anonymous grievance hotlines.

Month 1–6

8

Performance-Based Partner Contracting

Only 50% of partners rated good/excellent. Quarterly reviews; deregister repeat poor performers.

Month 3–6

9

Improve Data Quality & Monitoring Protocols

Validation rules in mobile data collection, 10% spot-check verification, quarterly data reviews.

Ongoing